Post-Its (Notes on a Marriage)

By Paul Dooley and Winnie Holzman

(There is a chair with a small table and a glass if *water on either side* if *the stage, ala A.* R. *Gurney's* Love Letters. *The* ACTOR *and* ACTRESS *enter simultaneously from either wing, dressed simply. Each grasps a handful* if *Post-its as if it were a script. They sit, modestly acknowledging each other and the audience. Each takes out a pair of reading glasses, puts them on. 'The* ACTOR *lifts his first Post-it to begin ... and reads. Every line is read from a Post-it.)*

INTRODUCTION

Actress: In today's society, everyone is so busy, it isn't any wonder than more and more of our communication happens via text message or written message left for our family members to find as we go about our hectic lives.
Actor: In Post-Its (Notes on a Marriage) by Paul Dooley and Winnie Holzman, the primary source of communication utilizes that cultural phenomenon of the Post-It.
Actress: Here you will find the ups and downs of a relationship that were unexpectedly captured on scraps of paper.

ACTOR: Had an early meeting, couldn't bear to wake you. Close front door hard or it won't lock. PS: Last night was incredible.

ACTRESS: Helped myself to breakfast. You need milk. PS: Next time, wake me.

ACTOR: Hey, sleepyhead. Tried to wake you. Not easy. Left you some coffee, hope you like it black.

ACTRESS: Thought I should spend at least one night this week at my place. Picked up some milk; you don't have to pay me back.

ACTOR: Off to work, extra set of keys on hall table.

ACTRESS: Darling: Went jogging with Lila. If you go out, we need milk. Wow. I can't believe we're a "we"!

ACTOR: Hon: If you have time, could you pick up my shirts? Ticket on hall table. Thanks. PS: Milk.

ACTRESS: Shirts are in your closet. Your mother called. She seemed surprised to

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

hear my voice. You obviously never mentioned me. *(Icy.)* Your shirts came to fourteen-fifty.

ACTOR: Gone to florist. Back soon. Hope you liked the chocolates.

ACTRESS: Darling, don't go in the den.

ACTOR: Sweetheart, I understand how much it means to you, but at this stage of our relationship I'm just not ready ... to have a dog.

ACTRESS: *(After a beat.)* We need Milk-Bones. *(Next Post-it.)* Your mother called; call her. *(Next Post-it.)* Did you call your mother? *(Next Post-it.)* Went to lunch with your mother. Back soon.

ACTOR: Your new best friend my mother called. Call her.

ACTRESS: We need milk. Also, your mom mentioned how much you hate Eugene. I don't think Eugene's so bad. You should hear *my* middle name. Thank God *my* mother's dead!

ACTOR: Please do not mention the name Eugene to me ever again. Thank you.

ACTRESS: Shopping list: Pistachio ice cream. Sardines. Those tiny little cheeses that come in that cute little net bag .... They're so adorable, they make me cry.

ACTOR: Darling: I understand how much it means to you, but at this stage of our relationship I'm just not ready-

ACTRESS: We need Pampers. And baby wipes. And we need to get married.

ACTOR: Meet me City Hall, six sharp. You bring old and borrowed; I'll do new and blue. Mom will stay with Eugenia.

ACTRESS: Note to self: Find breast pump.

ACTOR: Take cold shower.

ACTRESS: Lose forty pounds.

ACTOR: Redirect sex drive into career. *(Next Post-it.)* Home late. Don't wait up.

ACTRESS: Hey, stranger, if you're not too busy, could you call Eugenia tonight,

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

around bedtime? Just to see if she recognizes your voice?

ACTOR: Hon: Sorry about your birthday. PS: I got the raise!

ACTRESS: To the new vice president in charge of marketing. We need milk. Please advise.

ACTOR: Hon: I think we're out of milk. *(Next Post-it.)* Still no milk!

ACTRESS: If you want it so bad, get it yourself The milk train doesn't stop here anymore.

ACTOR: If you can't even manage to get to the store-get some household help!

ACTRESS: *(Icy.)* Have gone to bed. Dinner is in fridge. If there is something in particular you wish for dinner tomorrow night, please leave note to that effect, and I will have Ursula or Carla or *Jose*, if it's *heavy*, pick it up. *(Beat.)* I can't take this anymore! We barely- *(Turns Post-it over.)* - communicate! There's got to be more to this marriage than a few hastily scribbled words on a small square of pastel paper! *(Beat.)* By the way, we're out of Post-its.

ACTOR: You think I *want* to spend every night at the office? You have absolutely no concept of how a business is run.

ACTRESS: To Whom It May Concern: Regarding your Post-it of June the tenth, allow me to clarify my position-up yours. Eugenia and I will be at your mother's. PS: *You* need milk. (The ACTOR *glances over at the* ACTRESS, *she sips her water, coolly avoids his gaze. Finally ...*)

ACTOR: Call her at my mother's. *(Next Post-it.)* Must call her. *(Next Post-it.)* Reminder: Take out garbage. Call her. *(Next Post-it.)* People to call: Her. (The ACTOR *looks over again at the* ACTRESS. *She continues to ignore him.)*

ACTOR: Shopping list: Small loaf bread. Half pint milk. Soup for one. *(Next Post-it.)* Scotch for one. *(Next Post-it.)* Inflatable doll. *(Next Post-it.)* Scotch for two. (The ACTRESS *looks at him. He catches her eye. Caught, she hastily looks away.)*

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

ACTOR: Things to tell her. That I'm sorry. That I miss her. That all I want-all I ever wanted-is for her to be happy. (The ACTRESS *turns to him, touched by this. Then ... takes the next Post-it. Reads.)*

ACTRESS: We need milk.

ACTOR: Dearest-have gone down to the end of the driveway to get the paper. Back soon.

ACTRESS: Honey, that therapist called back. He can see you Monday.

ACTOR: Sweetie, your therapist says your Tuesday is now Friday.

ACTRESS: What a session! Dr. K. believes that part of me is locked in unconscious competition with you, and envious of your masculine role. By the way, we need cucumbers, sausages, and a really big zucchini.

ACTOR: At last-+a breakthrough today with Dr. G. It all became crystal clear. My mother. My father. *His* mother. You. *Your* mother. *(Turns Post-it over, continues.)* I see our entire marriage in a new light! I must free myself from the past so we can truly have a future. This changes everything.

ACTRESS: Hon: A Diet Coke exploded allover that note you left. Hope it wasn't important. *(He stares at her. Oblivious to his reaction, she reads the next Post-it.)* Took Eugenia to Brownies. Back soon.

ACTOR: Took Eugenia to kickboxing. Back soon.

ACTRESS: Took Eugenia to therapy. Could be a while.

ACTOR: Someone named Olaf called. Needs your resume. What resume?

ACTRESS: I landed the job! I start Monday! *(Next Post-it.)* Lastminute meeting. I'll try to call. *(Next Post-it.)* I'll be working late, don't wait up. *(Next Post-It.)* I'm glad you waited. Last night was incredible.

ACTOR: Drove Eugenia to DMV Hope she doesn't drive me home.

ACTRESS: Eugenia called. Loves college. Mentioned someone named Tyrone. Doesn't miss us at all.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

ACTOR: Pick up travel brochures.

ACTRESS: Eugenia called. When can we meet Tyrone?

ACTOR: Schedule trip to campus when we get back.

ACTRESS: Sweetheart: Travel agent called. Cruise is confirmed! The honeymoon we never had! A time for us to leave all this behind and enjoy ten glorious days of total togetherness. *(A long, silent beat. Very long. Very silent.* They *both look straight ahead. Finally he lifts the next Post-it.)*

ACTOR: *(With great relief.) God,* it's good to be home! *(Next Post- it.)* Dinner Wednesday with Eugenia and what's-his-name.

ACTRESS: Tyrone called-it's a boy. Kareem Eugene.

ACTOR: Eugenia called. Loves being a mom.

ACTRESS: Off to throw pots! Back soon! *(Next Post-it.)* Don't forget-we're bird-watching Thursday! *(Next Post-it.)* What night is good for square dancing?

ACTOR: Any night you want-we're free! Nothing to tie us down.

ACTOR: Eugenia called. Could we take Kareem for the weekend?

ACTRESS: Tyrone called. Could we take Kareem for spring break?

ACTOR: Kareem called. Could he spend the summer with us? Again. *(Next Post-it.)* Took Kareem to DMV

ACTRESS: Honey-last night was incredible. I couldn't believe how long it went on. You've *got* to do something about your snonng.

ACTOR: Shopping list: Bengay. Dentucreme. Viagra.

ACTRESS: Wrinkles Away. I-Can't-Believe-It's-Support-Hose. Estrogen in a Drum.

ACTOR: We need milk of magnesia.

ACTRESS: Call Medicare.

ACTOR: You left your keys in the door again.

ACTRESS: Do you have my keys?

ACTOR: I can't find my glasses.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

ACTRESS: Have you seen my cane?

ACTOR: How can I see your cane if I can't find my glasses?

ACTRESS: Gone for walk.

ACTOR: Where are you? Next time you go out, leave me a note!

ACTRESS: Sweetheart-dinner in oven. Taking nap. Love ya. *(There's a pause as lights slowly fade on the* ACTRESS. *Then …*)

ACTOR: Call Emily. Also cousin Ruthie. Send note to Father McKay and everyone who sent flowers. *(Beat.)* The service was lovely. Everybody said so. *(Beat.)* I was looking through your things for that locket you said Eugenia should have. I could hardly believe what I found. You'd saved every Post-it I ever wrote you. I wish I'd saved yours. I could be reading them now. *(Beat.)* Back soon. Going to the store. We need milk.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Paul Dooley and Winnie Holzman
Book: Laugh Lines: Short Comic Plays
ISBN: 978-0307277138
Publisher: Knopf Doubleday Publishing Group
Date (Month/Year): 2007

AWARD HISTORY

2009 National Qualifier
2011 National Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY